their policies. Deutsch understood international system as “clusters of settlement, modes of transport, centers of culture, areas of language, decisions of caste and class barriers between markets, sharp regional differences in wealth and interdependence”. Said[17] states that “what has been the ideological commitment of the traditional theorists became a devalued hypothesis to analyse causation in the real political world” for these theorists in IR.

The second Great Debate was neither won by the behaviouralists nor by the traditionalists and, gradually the controversies receded but left a long-lasting impact on the IR scholars, especially those from USA. Ultimately, this led to the reformulation of both realism and liberalism, both of which were highly influenced by the behaviouralist methodologies. The new avatars of realism and liberalism in the form of neo-realism and neo-liberalism again fermented the renewal of the first major debate in the 1970s. Side by side there sparked off another major debate between the neo-liberalism and neo-realism on one hand and neo-Marxism on the other. This ‘neo–neo’ debate came to constitute the third Great Debate of IR.

The neo-liberals renewed the old liberal ideas about the possibility of progress and change, but they discarded idealism. They tried to formulate theories and apply new methods that were scientific. Among several strands of neo-liberalism, the most prominent, which tried to face the realist challenge, was generally known as *pluralism,* and associated with it was the *Interdependence Model* of international relations. The chief proponents of the neo-liberal approach were E. Haas (Influential American Political Scientist), Robert Keohane[¶] and Joseph Nye[**].

The main line of thinking of this neo-liberal school was the plurality or multiplicity of actors. The neo-liberalists rejected the singular simplicities of the realist approach which considered states to be the only significant actors in international relations. This new school of liberal thought put a much greater emphasis on the plurality of actors and their activities in international relations. They acknowledged that side by side the UN and other regional organizations like the European Union (EU), Association of South East Asian Nations